



11 cm
4 1/4 in

MIMIC FILEFISH

Paraluteres prionurus

F: Monacanthidae

The mimic filefish is avoided by predators because it closely resembles the saddled pufferfish, which has toxic flesh.

flat back forms
top of bony
protective box

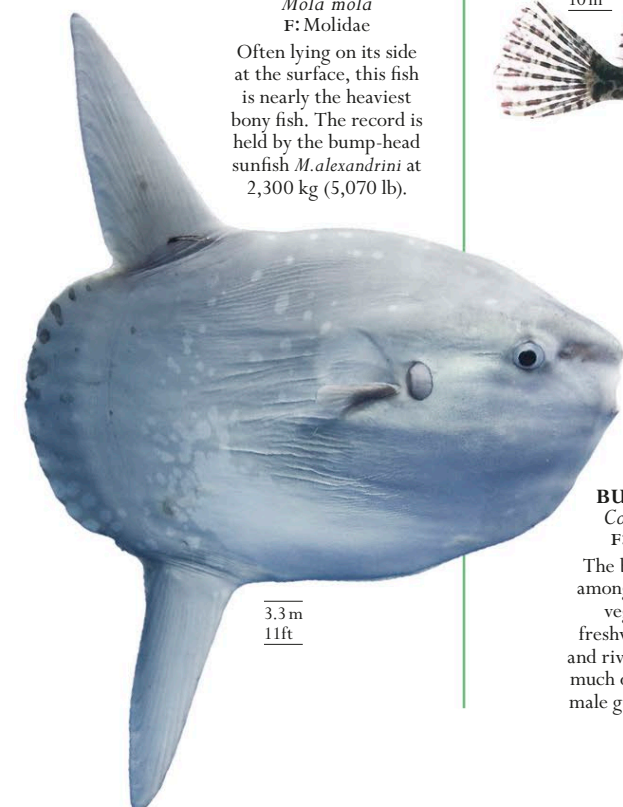


OCEAN SUNFISH

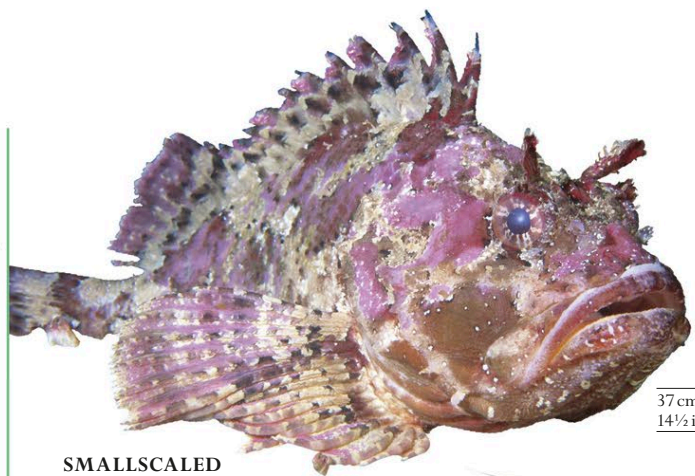
Mola mola

F: Molidae

Often lying on its side at the surface, this fish is nearly the heaviest bony fish. The record is held by the bump-head sunfish *M. alexandrini* at 2,300 kg (5,070 lb).



3.3 m
11 ft



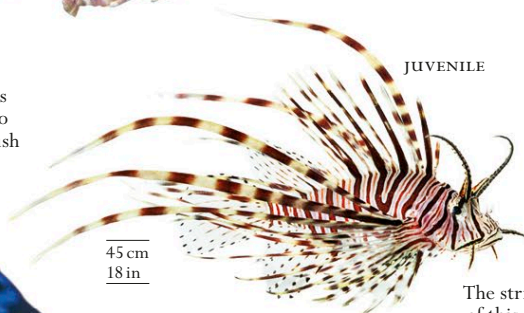
37 cm
14 1/2 in

SMALLSCALED SCORPIONFISH

Scorpaena porcus

F: Scorpaenidae

Well concealed by skin flaps on the head and its ability to change colour, the scorpionfish is hard to spot.



JUVENILE

45 cm
18 in

SCORPIONFISH AND RELATIVES

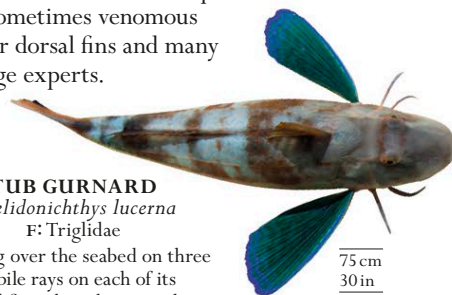
Mostly bottom-living and marine, fish in this large order have a large spiny head with a unique bony strut across the cheek. Most Scorpaeniformes have sharp, sometimes venomous spines in their dorsal fins and many are camouflage experts.

TUB GURNARD

Chelidonichthys lucerna

F: Triglidae

Walking over the seabed on three mobile rays on each of its pectoral fins, the tub gurnard can probe for hidden invertebrates.



75 cm
30 in

RED LIONFISH

Pterois volitans

F: Scorpaenidae

The striped colours warn predators that even juveniles of this coral-reef fish have venomous dorsal fin spines. Adults darken with age and can be almost black.



60 cm
23 1/2 in

LUMPSUCKER

Cyclopterus lumpus

F: Cyclopteridae

A strong sucker on the belly allows this rotund North Atlantic fish to cling onto wave-battered rocks and guard its eggs.



21 cm
8 1/2 in

BIG BAIKAL OILFISH

Comephorus baikalensis

F: Comephoridae

About a quarter of the body of this fish is oil, which provides it with buoyancy. It is endemic to Lake Baikal, Russia.



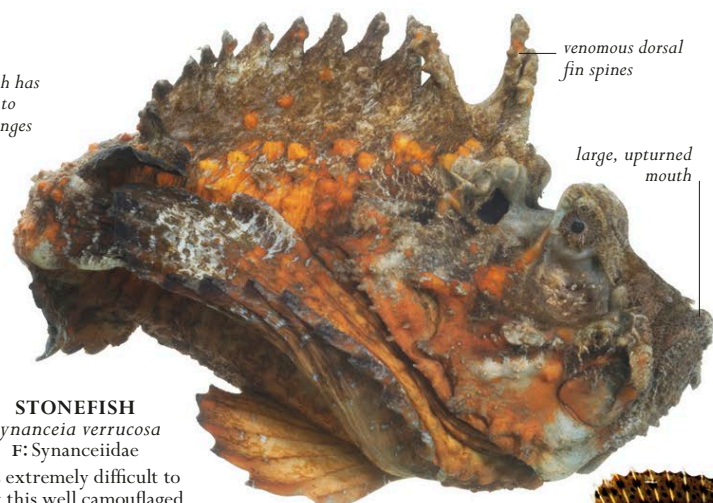
25 cm
10 in

LONGSPINED BULLHEAD

Taurulus bubalis

F: Cottidae

The colour of this coastal and shore fish varies widely, according to its background. For example, fish living amongst red seaweeds are red.



venomous dorsal
fin spines

large, upturned
mouth

STONEFISH

Synanceia verrucosa

F: Synanceiidae

It is extremely difficult to spot this well camouflaged tropical reef fish. A sting from its venomous spines can be fatal to humans.

40 cm
16 in



18 cm
7 in

BULLHEAD

Cottus gobio

F: Cottidae

The bullhead lives amongst stones and vegetation in freshwater streams and rivers throughout much of Europe. The male guards the eggs.



50 cm
20 in

FLYING GURNARD

Dactylopterus volitans

F: Dactylopteridae

This species uses its huge fan-like pectoral fins to "fly" through the water. It "takes off" from the seabed if disturbed.